Gwynedd Mercy University-School of Business & Education
(*Must be used for each lesson observed by University Supervisor*)
Lesson Plan Framework

Subject Area: Essential Skills (ESS) Grade Level: 9-13

Student Name: Grace Dittman

Domain I: Planning and Preparation	
PA Standard(s): • PA Career Education and Work Standard 13.3.11.A: Analyze how personal beliefs, attitudes, and behaviors affect decision-making and interactions with others. • PA SEL Competency — Self-Awareness: Identify and label emotions; recognize how emotions influence behavior.	
Essential Question(s): Students will consider and reflect on throughout the lesson: • How does being aware of our emotions affect the way we respond to situations? • How can understanding our emotions help us manage them in healthy ways?	
Objectives/Performance Expectations What will students know and be able to do as a result of this lesson? • Students will be able to identify the emotion a person might feel in a given situation. • Students will be able to explain how noticing a feeling before reacting (emotional awareness) affects the way a person responds to a situation. • Students will be able to identify at least one calming/coping strategy to use when experiencing a strong emotion. • Students will be able to describe how a specific emotion (e.g., fear, anger, sadness) can serve a helpful purpose.	
Assessment Evidence/Level of Learning Students will show what they know by evidence of/list names of formative or summative checks, quizzes, tests which indicate evidence of learning: • Verbal or nonverbal responses during the 'What Might They Do?' group situation activity	**Differentiated Instruction**: Modifications in instruction and assessment for students with learning differences, specifically those with 504's and IEP's. Extensions/Enrichment in instruction and assessment for students who are above grade level and/or gifted.

• Active participation in the guided breathing/calming exercise • Completed Emotional Awareness worksheet (ways emotions can help us) • Completed 'How Might You Feel' worksheet	• Visual schedule posted and referenced throughout to support predictability • Concrete, literal framing of abstract ideas (e.g., 'Situation → Feeling → What I Do' chain, feelings thermometer/scale) • Option to pass or respond nonverbally (pointing, writing) during group discussion • Simplified worksheet version with fewer scenarios and sentence starters for the student in the life skills program • Extra processing time before being asked to respond aloud • Teacher modeling and think-alouds provided before independent worksheet work

Domain II: Classroom Environment:

Describe Classroom/Behavior Management Plan & Routines

• Visual schedule displayed and referenced at the start of class and during transitions

• Consistent daily routine: check-in → daily engagement → group activity → direct instruction → independent worksheet → closure

• Clear verbal and visual cues signal transitions between activities

• Group discussion norms reinforced: one person talks at a time, 'pass' is always an option

• Calm, low-pressure tone maintained, especially during emotional-awareness discussion

Domain III: Instruction

Activate Prior Knowledge/Motivation:

• Students enter and complete their daily check-in using the visual schedule posted on the board.
• Daily engagement activity (Wordle, Contexto, or a set game) to settle in and warm up.
• Group activity — 'What Might They Do?': A situation is displayed on the board. Say: "I'm going to put a situation on the board. I want you to think, not about what emotion the person feels yet, but about what they might do in that moment. There's no wrong answer, we're just guessing together." Take several guesses per situation.
• Ask: "If it's the same situation, why might two people react differently?" (Pause for guesses.) Say: "A lot of the time, it comes down to the feeling underneath the action. What someone feels affects what they do, even when they don't realize it's happening." This motivates today's focus on emotional

awareness.

Preparing students for the lesson: How will you activate prior knowledge, build background, or review previous lessons as well as motivate students for the lesson?

Materials Needed:

- Whiteboard/projector with visual schedule and situation prompts
- Daily engagement activity (Wordle/Contexto/set game)
- Emotional Awareness worksheet (ways our emotions can help us)
- "How Might You Feel" worksheet
- Breathing/calming meditation video
- Pencils

Vocabulary (New or Review):

- Emotional awareness — noticing what you are feeling, especially before it turns into an action
- Trigger — the situation or event that causes a feeling
- Coping/calming strategy — a tool used to manage a strong feeling
- React vs. respond — reacting automatically vs. pausing to choose an action

Sequence of the Lesson:

- Introduce emotional awareness: "That's what we're focusing on today, not just what people do, but the feeling that's driving it. This is called emotional awareness, noticing what you're feeling, and noticing it before it turns into an action you didn't mean to do."
- Explain why awareness matters: "Feelings happen fast, and sometimes we react before we even realize what we're feeling. But if you pause and notice 'hey, I'm feeling frustrated' or 'I'm feeling nervous,' that little bit of awareness gives you a moment to decide what to do next, instead of just reacting on autopilot." Note that this pause also gives you a chance to use a calming/coping strategy.
- Introduce the idea that emotions have a purpose: "Big emotions don't always feel good, but even uncomfortable emotions are trying to help us in some way, they're giving us information. Today's worksheet is about figuring out what that information is, and how each emotion can actually work for us instead of against us."
- Give examples before handing out the Emotional Awareness worksheet: Fear/Nervousness → keeps us safe or prepared ("If you feel nervous before a test, that's your brain telling you 'this matters, get ready.' That nervous feeling can actually push you to study or review your notes."); Anger/Frustration → signals something feels unfair or a boundary was crossed ("If you feel frustrated when a friend keeps interrupting you, that feeling is pointing out that something doesn't feel right, and it might be a signal to speak up or ask for space.")
- Read through the Emotional Awareness worksheet instructions together and have students answer the question at the bottom.
- Transition to the calming tool: "We talked about how being aware of how you are feeling can affect your actions: when you notice a feeling before you react, you get a chance to choose your response instead of just reacting automatically. But noticing a feeling is only the first step. Sometimes,

especially with big feelings, frustration, anxiety, anger, noticing isn't enough on its own. You also need a way to actually calm that feeling down before you can think clearly and choose your next move. That's where having a tool comes in. One simple tool is a short breathing or calming exercise, something you can use anytime a feeling starts to feel like too much. Let's practice one right now, together, so it's already familiar for whenever you actually need it."

- Play guided breathing/calming meditation video as a whole group.
- Introduce independent practice: "Okay, now I want you to practice being aware of your emotions. You have a worksheet called 'How Might You Feel.' I want you to read through these scenarios and write down how you might feel in these situations. You don't have to write this part down, but I want you to think about what you might do to make yourself feel better in these situations or what your emotions in these situations mean."
- Students work independently on the 'How Might You Feel' worksheet; circulate to support as needed.

What learning activities/strategies will you use to engage the students in the learning? What will students do to use and apply new concepts or skills (independent practice if relevant)? How will you monitor and guide their performance? Include relevant vocabulary. Use bullets to sequence your lesson.

Closure: What will you do to bring closure to the lesson? How will you summarize this lesson and preview the lesson that will follow?

- Students hand in both worksheets (Emotional Awareness and How Might You Feel).
- Briefly recap the big idea: noticing a feeling gives you a chance to choose your response, and calming tools help when a feeling gets big.
- Preview that tomorrow's lesson will continue building on these skills.
- Students with time remaining work on any missing assignments.

Reflection Guidelines

The student will write lesson plans with an eye to the Danielson Framework and the Four Domains of Professional Practice. Use this as a resource when writing lesson plans.

Domain I Planning and Preparation

1. How do you know you were knowledgeable of your content?
2. What is the evidence that your objective was clear in the lesson plan?
3. How does the lesson address individual student learning needs?
4. What variety of strategies and methodologies did you consider when planning?
5. What is the evidence that lesson components were logically sequenced?
6. How did your lesson plan include checks for student understanding?
7. What PA Standards did this lesson address?

Domain II Classroom Environment

1. How did students know the behavioral and academic expectations for the lesson?
2. What effective routines and procedures did you implement for lesson efficiency?
3. How did you insure the classroom was physically accessible for all learners?
4. What evidence indicates that respect was shown between and among students and teacher?
5. What evidence indicates that students placed a high value on quality participation, process, and product?
6. How do you assess if the lesson was attainable for all students but also had appropriate rigor?

Domain III Instructional Delivery

1. How did you align your lesson to PA Standards?
2. How did you insure a clearly stated objective, understood by learners?
3. How did you provide clear explanations as to how to proceed through the lesson?
4. What questioning and discussion techniques insured all-learner participation?
5. What strategies did you employ to engage all students?
6. Describe how you made the content meaningful due to sequencing and pacing.
7. Discuss how you checked for understanding, provided feedback, retaught.
8. What is the evidence that you were you flexible and responsive to the needs of the learners?
9. Describe how you made meaning of the lesson with some form of closure activity.

Overall Assessment

Briefly state any changes you will make the next time you teach this lesson or activity, to improve any of the Domains of Professional Practice.